

FREE BUYER'S GUIDE

The 7-Point EVSE Supplier Verification Checklist

The exact checks I run before recommending any China supplier of portable chargers, charging cables, or wallboxes.

Most sourcing failures aren't bad luck. They're predictable — and catchable before you wire a single dollar.

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Run these 7 checks.

After 12 years on the manufacturing side, I've learned that the buyers who get burned almost always skipped the same handful of checks. Here's the short version of what I run on every supplier.

1 Business Legitimacy

Real factory, or a trading company in disguise? Verify the business license and that the registered scope of business actually includes *manufacturing* — not just wholesale/trade.

Red flag: company name on the quote doesn't match the certificates or the bank account.

2 Certification — Required, or Nice to Have?

First ask whether your *market* legally requires a formal cert. If yes, expect a higher price + minimum volume (a real cert carries recurring cost, amortized over units). If not, a factory that truly builds to standard may not hold a live cert — what matters is a genuine certificate **or** a full test report (IEC 61851-1 / UL 2594 / IEC 62752).

Red flag: a forged or "borrowed" certificate — or neither a cert nor any test data.

3 Production Capacity

Can they deliver your volume, on your timeline? Ask how much capacity is *already committed*, and for their last 3 months' real on-time delivery rate — not a promise.

Red flag: vague answers on current capacity utilization.

4 Quality Control System

Do they test every unit, or sample and pray? For safety-critical tests like hipot and ground continuity, the answer must be **100%**, not sampled. Look for a working aging station and calibrated equipment.

Red flag: hipot test logs that look identical across batches — a sign of fabricated data.

5 Component & BOM Transparency

What's actually inside? The #1 cost-down trick is the golden-sample bait-and-switch. Under-spec copper in a charging cable runs hot — a real fire risk.

Red flag: refusal to disclose component brands, or cable weight noticeably below spec.

6 Target-Market Compliance

Right standard, right connector, right paperwork. CCS1 and CCS2 are physically incompatible — ship the wrong one and the whole container is scrap.

Red flag: the supplier never asks which market you're shipping to.

7 Communication & Responsiveness

Pre-sale is a supplier's best behavior. If responses are slow, vague, or non-technical *now*, it gets far worse once your money is gone and there's a dispute.

Red flag: only a salesperson relaying messages, never an engineer.



If you only have time for three, never skip #2, #4, and #6. Those are the ones that turn into total losses — not just headaches.

WANT A SECOND PAIR OF EYES?

Want these 7 checks run on a specific supplier?

That's exactly what I do. For a single named supplier, I deliver a documented, evidence-backed report — so you know what you're paying for before the deposit leaves your account.

- ✓ A documented report scoring all 7 points (pass / risk / fail, with evidence)
- ✓ A live video factory walk-through
- ✓ Certification database verification (UL / CE / Notified Body)
- ✓ A red-flag summary you can act on before you wire a deposit

Supplier Verification Report — from **\$490**

100% credited toward your fee if you go on to full sourcing.

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